

Katrin Merfeld

Associate Professor · Utrecht University School of Economics

Research: Sustainability marketing · nature-based solutions · sharing economies · consumer behaviour

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Appointments

2025-present	Associate Professor, Marketing & Business Development, Utrecht University School of Economics
2020-2025	Assistant Professor, Marketing & Business Development, Utrecht University School of Economics
2018-2020	Postdoctoral Researcher, EBS University
2015-2018	Research Assistant, EBS University

Education

Since 2023	Habilitation research, EBS University, Wiesbaden
2015-2018	Dr. rer. pol., summa cum laude, EBS University; dissertation in consumer behaviour
2014-2016	Diplôme du Programme Grande École, KEDGE Business School, Bordeaux
2013-2015	MSc Marketing, EBS University
2010-2013	BSc Business Administration, University of Mannheim

Research and teaching

Research spans sustainability marketing, the value and communication of urban nature, sharing and mobility, technology-enabled services, and alternative modes of consumption. Current European projects include NATURESCAPES and ClimEx-PE.

Programme coordinator for the MSc Business and Social Impact. Master's teaching includes Sustainability Marketing and Platform Economy & Business.

Funding and recognition

Major collaborative grants

Principal investigator, NWO Water4All / ClimEx-PE (approximately EUR 270,000 to USE). Work package co-lead, Horizon Europe / NATURESCAPES (approximately EUR 6.5 million total; EUR 560,000 to USE).

Additional grants

- 2023** REBO USE Teaching Innovation Grant, Sustainability Marketing Challenge; REBO USO Teaching Innovation Grant, Alumni Network
- 2022** EWUU Alliance Grant, Circular and Socially Inclusive Real Estate; Pathways to Sustainability funding for NATURICITY and Sharing Paradoxes
- 2021** REBO USO grants for Workboost and the BSI Challenge; EWUU Alliance Grant for platforms for urban nature-based solutions

EBS Upcoming Scholar Award (2020); SRH Social Impact Thesis Award (2018).

Academic service and supervision

Editorial board member, Humanities & Social Sciences Communications. Reviewer for Journal of Business Research, Journal of Service Research, Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services, Organization & Environment, Psychology & Marketing, Technological Forecasting and Social Change, and Transportation Research Parts A and C, among others.

PhD supervision: Anne-Sophie Riegger, Christopher Großmann, Max Mulhuijzen, Philip Fitschen, Vera Schwarzmann, Fahim Schaffi, Jihwan Ryu, and Madeleine Neumann. Postdoctoral mentoring: Charlotte Demosant and Jessica Lillquist.

Languages: German (native), English (C2), Dutch (B2), French (A2), Spanish (A1), Latin (Latinum).

Seminars and knowledge exchange

- 2025** Urban NBS Day on law and nature-based solutions; presentation on business models for nature-based solutions at the Presencing Institute; collaboration with the German World Shops
- 2024** Urban NBS Day on health and nature-based solutions; NATURESCAPES fieldwork and stakeholder workshops; NATURESCAPES Collaboratory meetings
- 2023** Urban NBS Day on inclusivity in real estate, Dutch Design Week exhibition, and presentations on nature-based solutions and sustainable business models
- 2022** Workshops with UNICEF Germany and German World Shops; Urban NBS Day on co-financing and digitalisation for nature-based solutions
- 2021** Research seminars at EBS University, Utrecht University, and the University of Surrey; presentation to the Global Alliance for Banking on Values / MIT Community Innovators Lab

Publications

Peer-reviewed articles and other scholarly work

2025

- Merfeld, K., Klein, J. F., de Regt, A., Baltin (née Riegger), A. S., & Henkel, S. In-store technology personalization: A typology and research agenda based on type of automation and data collection. *Journal of Business Research*, 191, 115236.
- Benoit, S., Merfeld, K., Tunn, V. S. C., Schaefers, T., & Andreassen, T. W. The B2B sharing economy: Framework, implications, and future research. *Journal of Business Research*, 191, 115244.
- Schwarzmann, V., Merfeld, K., & Kreutzer, K. Navigating age diversity in volunteer teams: Barriers and enablers of teamwork. *Nonprofit and Voluntary Sector Quarterly*, 54(3), 547-582.
- Oetken, K. J., Hennig, K., Henkel, S., & Merfeld, K. A psychoanalytical approach in urban design: Exploring dynamics of co-creation through theme-centred interaction. *Journal of Urban Design*, 30(4), 445-472.

2024

- Perera, C., Toxopeus, H., Klein, S., & Merfeld, K. Enabling justice for nature-based solutions in real estate development. *Nature-Based Solutions*, 6, 100148.
- Fitschen, P., Merfeld, K., Klein, J. F., & Henkel, S. Understanding the urban mobility challenge: Why shared mobility providers fail to attract car drivers. *Transport Policy*, 158, 104-111.
- Terpoorten, C., Klein, J. F., & Merfeld, K. Understanding B2B customer journeys for complex digital services: The case of cloud computing. *Industrial Marketing Management*, 119, 178-192.
- de Jong, J. P. J., Mulhuijzen, M., Merfeld, K., Rigtering, C., van Balen, T., & Boënné, M. Industrial product development with lead users as a source of Schumpeterian opportunity. *Journal of Product Innovation Management*, 41(6), 1165-1183.
- Großmann, C., Merfeld, K., Klein, J. F., Föller, F., & Henkel, S. Onto the light side of sharing: Using the force of blockchain. *Journal of Business Research*, 175, 114507.

2023

- Timmer, S., Merfeld, K., & Henkel, S. Exploring motivations for multimodal commuting: A hierarchical means-end chain analysis. *Transportation Research Part A: Policy and Practice*, 176, 103831.

2022

- Riegger, A. S., Merfeld, K., Klein, J. F., & Henkel, S. Technology-enabled personalization: Impact of smart technology choice on consumer shopping behavior. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 181, 121752.
- Klein, J. F., Merfeld, K., Wilhelms, M. P., Falk, T., & Henkel, S. Buying to share: How prosumption promotes purchases in peer-to-peer asset sharing. *Journal of Business Research*, 143, 171-183.

2021

- Riegger, A. S., Klein, J. F., Merfeld, K., & Henkel, S. Technology-enabled personalization in retail stores: Understanding drivers and barriers. *Journal of Business Research*, 123, 140-155.

2020

Lehr, A., Buettgen, M., Benoit, S., & Merfeld, K. Spillover effects from unintended trials on attitude and behavior: Promoting new products through access-based services. *Psychology & Marketing*, 37(5), 705-723.

2019

Merfeld, K., Wilhelms, M. P., & Henkel, S. Being driven autonomously: A qualitative study to elicit consumers' overarching motivational structures. *Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies*, 107, 229-247.

Merfeld, K., Wilhelms, M. P., Henkel, S., & Kreutzer, K. Carsharing with shared autonomous vehicles: Uncovering drivers, barriers and future developments - A four-stage Delphi study. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 144, 66-81.

2017

Wilhelms, M. P., Merfeld, K., & Henkel, S. Yours, mine, and ours: A user-centric analysis of opportunities and challenges in peer-to-peer asset sharing. *Business Horizons*, 60(6), 771-781.

Reports, books and working papers

Bulkeley, H., Lacambra, C., Barnwal, A., Blackwatters, J. J., Callenberg, M., Demonsant, C., Fransen, A., Jeong, J., Kinniburgh, F., Lillquist, J., Maia, S., Merfeld, K., & Toxopeus, H. (2026). Integration, Financing and Just Transition for Urban Sustainability. The British Academy. Research report.

Toxopeus, H., & Merfeld, K. (2023). Exploring business models for sustainability with nature as a key resource: A case study of urban nature-based solutions. SSRN working paper.

Merfeld, K. (2018). Shared and autonomous: A market perspective on contemporary mobility. Doctoral dissertation.

Wilhelms, M. P., Henkel, S., & Merfeld, K. (2017). You are what you share: Understanding participation motives in peer-to-peer carsharing. In *Disrupting Mobility: Impacts of Sharing Economy and Innovative Transportation on Cities* (pp. 105-119). Springer.

Conference presentations

Kreutzer, K., Schwarzmann, V., Merfeld, K., Vaara, E. Organizational Purpose As Ideological Struggle: Uncovering Longitudinal Dynamics In Fair Trade Worldshops Germany. 41st EGOS Colloquium 2025, Athens, GR.

Toxopeus, H., Merfeld, K. Capturing the Value of Nature Together: Developing Business Models for Urban Nature-Based Solutions. AoM 2025, Copenhagen, DK.

Boënnne, M., Merfeld, K. Grohsjean, T.W. How Competitive vs. Collaborative Team Familiarity Can Affect Creative Processes. AoM 2025, Copenhagen, DK.

Neumann, M., Kuhn, M., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Pathways to Equity? Examining the societal impacts of AI-enabled mobility solutions using TCCM Analysis. Academy of Marketing Science (AMS) Annual Conference 2025, Montreal, CA

Toxopeus, H., Merfeld, K. Developing Business Models for Urban Nature-Based Solutions. IABS 2025, Maastricht, NL.

Boënnne, M., Merfeld, K. Grohsjean, T.W. How competitive familiarity affects idea divergence and convergence in a role-playing game-based design thinking process. EURAM 2024, Bath, UK

Schwarzmann, V., Kreutzer, K., Merfeld, K., From activism to movement fatigue: The mainstreaming of fair-trade in Germany. 39th EGOS Colloquium 2023, Cagliari, IT

Boënnne, M., Merfeld, K. How competitive familiarity affects idea divergence and convergence in a role-playing game-based design thinking process. Accepted for presentation at the RSPM symposium 'Design for Debate' Utrecht, NL

Schwarzmann, V., Merfeld, K., Kreutzer, K. Age Diversity in Volunteer Teams: A Qualitative Study on Age-Diverse Teamwork. 2022 AoM Annual Conference, Seattle, WA

Toxopeus, H., Merfeld, K. Capturing the Value of Nature together. 38th EGOS Colloquium 2022, Vienna, AUT

Fitschen, P., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Why New Mobility Providers Fail to Attract Car Drivers: A Behavioral Accounting Perspective. EMAC 2021 Annual Conference, Madrid, SP

- Riegger, A.-S., Klein, J.F., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Technology-Enabled Personalization: The Impact of Device Choice on Consumer Reactance. EMAC 2021 Annual Conference, Madrid, SP
- Klein, J.F., Wilhelms, M.-P., Merfeld, K., Buying to share: How peer-to-peer asset sharing services promote product purchase. Seventh International Workshop on the Sharing Economy 2021, Barcelona, SP
- Merfeld, K., Großmann, C., Henkel, S. Consumer perception of Blockchain-based Peer- to-peer Mobility Sharing Services. Seventh International Workshop on the Sharing Economy 2021, Barcelona, SP
- Schwarzmann, V., Kreutzer, K., Merfeld, K. Age-diversity in volunteer teams – A qualitative study on intergenerational teamwork. 37th EGOS Colloquium 2021, Amsterdam, NL
- Merfeld, K., Großmann, C., Henkel, S. Consumer Perception of Blockchain-Based Autonomous Mobility. ACIEK 2021 Annual Conference, Paris, FR
- Klein, J.F., Wilhelms, M.-P., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S., How Peer-to-Peer Sharing Promotes Product Purchase. Academy of Marketing Science (AMS) Annual Conference
- Klein, J.F., Wilhelms, M.-P., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S., Falk, T. Buying to Share: How Peer-to-Peer Sharing Promotes Product Purchase. Frontiers in Services Conference 2019, Singapore
- Timmer, S., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S., Exploring Usage Motives for Corporate Multimodal Mobility Services: A Hierarchical Means-Analysis. Academy of Marketing Science (AMS) Annual Conference 2019, Vancouver, BC
- Riegger, A.-S., Merfeld, K., Klein, J. F., Henkel, S. Experiential Retail for Luxury Brands: Using Non Traditional Stores to Reach Untapped Customer Segments. Frontiers in Services Conference 2019, Singapore
- Großmann, C., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. A Consumer Perspective on Blockchain Technology in Shared Mobility Services. 2019 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA
- Großmann, C., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Mining Public Perception - Blockchain-based Services in Mainstream Media. 2019 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA
- Merfeld, K., Wilhelms, M.-P., Henkel, S. Dear or Dare? A Qualitative Study to Elicit Consumers' Motives Associated with Autonomous Driving. 2018 American Marketing Association (AMA) Summer Conference, Boston, MA
- Klein, J.F., Wilhelms, M.-P., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Value Creation in Peer-to-Peer Asset- Sharing. 2018 American Marketing Association (AMA) Summer Conference, Boston, MA
- Merfeld, K., Kreutzer, K. A Better World through Autonomous Driving? Responsibilities and Moral Dilemmas. INFORMS International Conference 2018, Taipei, TWN
- Riegger, A.-S., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Personalizing the In-store Experience – An Experimental Research Design. INFORMS International Conference 2018, Taipei, TWN
- Merfeld, K., Wilhelms, M.-P., Henkel, S., & Kreutzer, K. The Future of Autonomous Carsharing - A Delphi Study. INFORMS Annual Meeting 2017, Houston, TX
- Merfeld, K., Wilhelms, M.-P. The Future of Shared Transportation - The Case of Carsharing with Shared Autonomous Vehicles – An International Expert Study. IFITT Surrey Think Tank: Collaborative Economy, Surrey, UK
- Merfeld, K. From Nightmares to good Drive's sleep – Understanding the autonomous Customer. 2017 International VDI Conference, Berlin, GER
- Merfeld, K., Wilhelms, M.-P. Drivers of Autonomous Vehicle Adaption – A Qualitative Assessment of Consumers' Motives. 2017 ASSA Annual Meeting – American Economic Association, Chicago, IL
- Wilhelms, M.-P., Merfeld, K. Peer-to-Peer Carsharing: Investigating Car Owners' Participation Motives – A Qualitative Study. 2017 ASSA Annual Meeting – American Economic Association, Chicago, IL
- Sowik, N., Merfeld, K., Wilhelms, M.-P. The Mediated Effect of Psychological Ownership on Loyalty in Access-Based Consumption. The Case of Carsharing. 2017 ASSA Annual Meeting – American Economic Association, Chicago, IL
- Wilhelms, M.-P., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Who Uses Peer-to-Peer Carsharing Anyhow? - Insights Into Motives for Peer-to-Peer Carsharing Usage American Marketing Association (AMA) Summer Conference, Atlanta, GA
- Wilhelms, M.-P., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Get What You Want - a Qualitative Study to Elicit Renters' Participation Motives in Peer-to-Peer Carsharing. SASE Annual Conference 2016 – UC Berkeley, Berkeley, CA
- Merfeld, K., & Wilhelms, M.-P., Henkel, S. What Drives Autonomous Vehicle Adaption? A Qualitative Study to Elicit Consumer's Motives. INFORMS International Conference 2016, Waikoloa, HI
- Wilhelms, M.-P., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Understanding Peer-to-Peer Carsharing Users – A Qualitative Study to Elicit Users' Participation Motives. INFORMS International Conference 2016, Waikoloa, HI
- Wilhelms, M.-P., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Understanding Users of Peer-to-Peer Carsharing Users – A Qualitative Study to Elicit Users' Participation Motives. Academy of Marketing Science (AMS) Annual Conference 2016, Orlando, FL
- Wilhelms, M.-P., Merfeld, K., Henkel, S. Why Rent a Car from a Private Person? A Means-End Analysis to Uncover Peer-Users' Participation Motives in Peer-to-Peer Carsharing. 2nd International Workshop on the Sharing Economy, Paris, FR